

 AGNTCON EUROPE 2026 · AMSTERDAM

A New Way To Build Software

How GitHub is evolving for a human, agent future



Marlene Mhangami

DevEx at GitHub

 [marlenezw](#)  [marlene_zw](#)



GITHUB OCTOVERSE 2025

More Code Is Being Created

PULL REQUESTS MERGED / MONTH

43.2M

▲ 23% YoY

Pull requests merged each month in 2025.

COMMITTS PUSHED IN 2025

986M

▲ 25% YoY

Nearly a billion commits, GitHub's most active year ever.



2023 TO AUGUST 2026

The Scale Of The Shift

MERGED PULL REQUESTS PER MONTH

130M



COMMITTS PER MONTH

2.9B



NEW REPOS PER MONTH

24M



GitHub reached 1.15B commits per week in August 2026. Weekly statistic; graphs above show monthly activity.

Charts: GitHub Blog, "The August 17 outage, and the work ahead," 2026. Weekly figure: GitHub Corp Comms external reference tracker.



JANUARY TO AUGUST 2026

Automation Is Compounding

COMPLETED GITHUB ACTIONS RUNS

115.4M

▲ nearly 4x since January

August peak, up from roughly 15M to 30M early in 2026.

GROWTH IN COMPLETED GITHUB ACTIONS RUNS



Azure now serves roughly 58% of GitHub's platform load, up from 12% in May. That expanded footprint supported this growth.

Source: GitHub Blog, "The August 17 outage, and the work ahead," 2026.



THE SHIFT SO FAR

What's Changed?



More Code

Monthly commits doubled in four months, from 1.4B to 2.9B.



More Automation

Completed Actions runs grew nearly 4x this year.



Much Of It Co-Authored By AI Agents

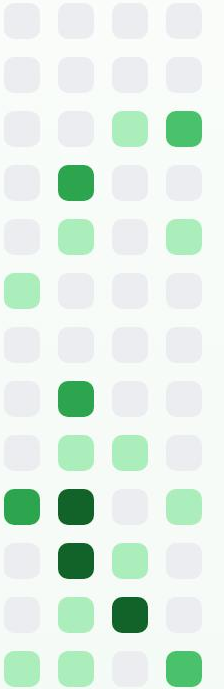
17.8M

Agent-created pull requests in March 2026 alone.

Agent-created pull requests quadrupled in six months. Commit and Actions figures from the August 17 outage post.

Sources: GitHub Blog, 2026, and GitHub Corp Comms external reference tracker.

How have these changes affected developers?





ISSUES AND REACTIONS ON GITHUB

Developers and AI

MORE AGENTIC

Give agents more reach

✓ anthropics/claude-code#6235

👍 5,153

Feature request: support AGENTS.md

✓ github/copilot-cli#33

👍 110

Support OAuth HTTP MCP servers

✓ cli/cli#13256

👍 188

Attach local images to comments, issues, and pull requests

MORE CONTROL

Keep humans in charge

⦿ tldraw/tldraw#7695

👍 194

Contributions policy: automatically closing external pull requests

✓ RsyncProject/rsync#934

👍 159

Remove all LLM generated commits before people get hurt by this nonsense

⦿ NixOS/nixpkgs#551976

👍 76

Instantly close PRs that do not contain the automation/AI disclosure

The same platform, pulled in two directions at once. Reaction counts as of September 2026.
Source: public issues on GitHub.



WHAT COMES NEXT

The Modern GitHub Experience

01



Issues

Where the work gets defined.

02



Pull Requests

Where the work gets reviewed.

03



Maintainer Controls

Where the rules get set.



~/agntcon-mcpcon-europe-2026 git:(main)

> gh issue comment 1 --attach broken-title-slide.png

<https://github.com/marlenezw/agntcon-mcpcon-europe-2026/issues/1#issuecomment-4821007>

> █

--attach

uploads the image and rewrites the reference in the comment body.

+ New

My work

Automations

Customize

Projects



Chats

- Hello
- New conversation
- Slack capability
- OSF thumbnail update
- New chat
- Coding agents
- Building shareable canvases
- OSF calendar invite admin

Show more



Marlene



Customers cannot see any prices. This affects the default page load, not an edge case.

```
![Every price renders as $NaN](evidence/menu-before.png)' \
```

```
--attach 'evidence/menu-before.png#Every price on the menu renders as $NaN, with an error banner at the top'
```

<https://github.com/marlenezw/monas-cafe/issues/4>
<shellId: 9 completed with exit code 0>

Started Sep 2, 2026 · 11:58 AM

Duration 2.4s out 2 lines · 88 B

Thought for 7s

Delegate a task. Use / for commands, @ files, & sessions, # issues...



Issue #4 ×

Impact

Customers cannot see any prices. This affects the default page load, not an edge case.

Monas Cafe

Home Menu Visit

We couldn't load prices for this menu.
Something went wrong formatting item prices. Please refresh, or ask at the counter. `MenuPriceError`

Today's Menu

Roasted out back · Baked this morning

ESPRESSO BAR

Espresso Merge

HOUSE FAVORITE

Double shot, zero conflicts.

\$NaN

Latte Rebase

NEW

Interactive, with oat milk.

\$NaN

Flat White Fork

Same base, slightly different history.

\$NaN

Cortado Commit

Small, dense, and well described.

\$NaN

BREW BAR

Cold Brew Branch

Steeped 18 hours, well off main.

\$NaN

Pour Over Push

Single origin, Ethiopia. Slow and worth it.

\$NaN

Octo Chai

SEASONAL

Eight spices. Obviously.

\$NaN

FROM THE BAKERY

Merge Conflict Croissant

Floppy, but it resolves beautifully.

\$NaN

Blame Bagel

Everything seasoning. We know who did it.

\$NaN

Stash Scone

Saved for later. Still warm.

\$NaN

Order total (incl. 8.75% tax) **\$NaN**

marlenezw - zsh

~/agntcon-mcpcon-europe-2026 > gh stack submit --auto

Created PR #2 for fix/title-slide-path

Created PR #6 for feat/share-notes

Created PR #7 for feat/notes-styling

Pushed and synced 3 branches

✓ Stack created on GitHub with 3 PRs

~/agntcon-mcpcon-europe-2026 >



Fix title slide image 404 (incorrect path) #2

Staff



Open

1/3



marlenezw

broken-title-slide



fix/title-slide-path



+7 -1



Overview

Commits 2

Checks 0

Files changed 1



Comments to address

Address the open review comments and ask for another review.

Merge when ready



Checks 0/1



Resolved comments 1/2



Activity (since this pull request was created)

- 1 new commit
- 5 review comments
- 5 requested reviews
- View all activity

Reviewers

Copilot Lite



KEEPING HUMANS IN CONTROL

Maintainer Controls



01

Collaborators only

SHIPPED, JUNE 2026

Restrict who can open issues to people with write access. Every public entry point closes with it: issues, comments, Discussions, Projects and Copilot.



02

Agent automation controls

PUBLIC PREVIEW, JULY 2026

Agents suggest instead of apply. Labels, types, assignments and closures wait for approval, auto-apply above a confidence threshold you set, and record a rationale for every action.



03

Triage role exceptions

SHIPPED, AUGUST 2026

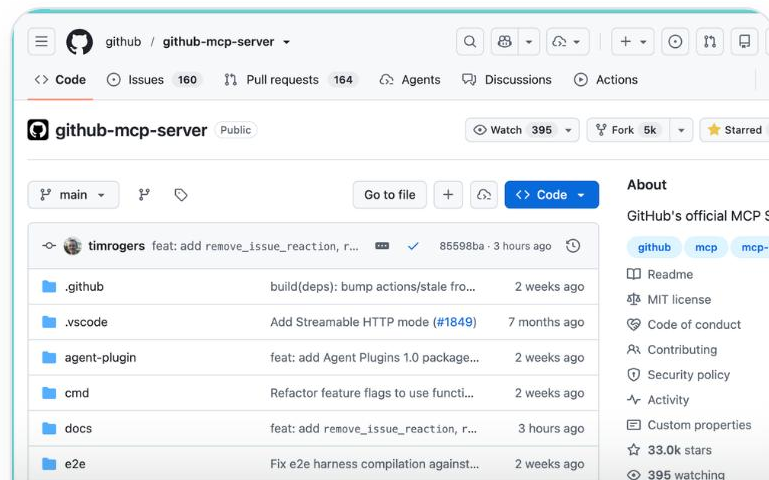
Delegate without reopening the door. Trusted triagers keep filing and sorting issues while the restriction stays on for everyone else.

Gate the front door. Delegate safely. Keep agents on a leash inside the issue.

Source: GitHub Changelog, June to August 2026.

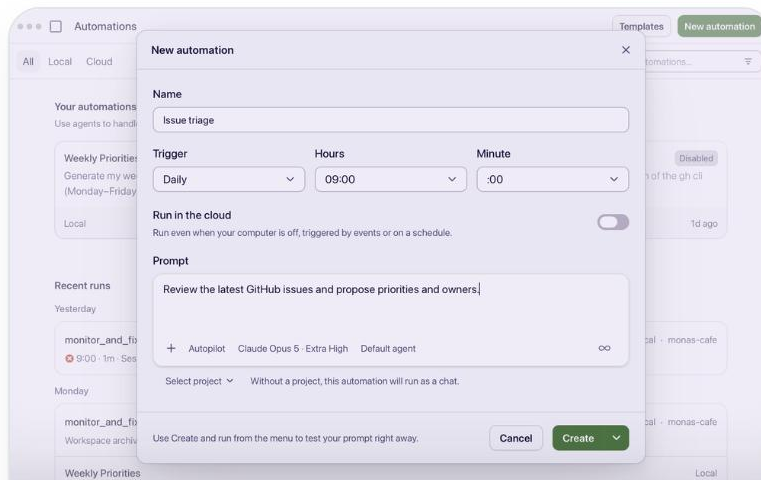
GitHub across multiple agentic surfaces

One platform. Meet your agents wherever the work already happens.



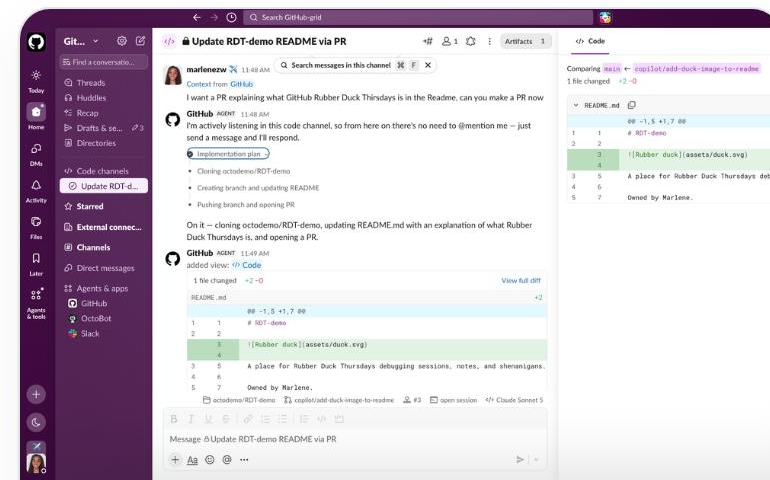
MCP

The GitHub MCP server connects issues, pull requests, and Actions to any agent.



Automations

Scheduled agentic workflows that kick off and keep running on their own.



Slack + Teams

Delegate to Copilot and track the work right inside your team chat.

Thank you

A new way to build software

Slides

marlenezw.github.io/agntcon-mcpcon-europe-2026

Code

github.com/marlenezw/agntcon-mcpcon-europe-2026

GITHUB **marlenezw**

X **marlene_zw**

LINKEDIN **marlenemhangami**